

ColorGenius Beta — Stylist Onboarding Guide

Welcome to the future of hair color formulation.

What Is ColorGenius?

ColorGenius is an AI-powered hair color formulation tool that analyzes your client's hair through a photo, combines it with their treatment history, and delivers a precise formula — shades, developer, ratios, and processing time — in seconds.

It's like having a senior colorist in your pocket, helping you nail color on the first try, every time.

Beta app: app.colorgenius.ai **Support:** beta@colorgenius.ai **Urgent/safety:** urgent@colorgenius.ai

Getting Started

Step 1: Access the App

ColorGenius runs in your browser — no app store download needed.

1. Open **app.colorgenius.ai** on your phone, tablet, or computer
2. Click **"Join Beta"**
3. Enter your invitation code (sent to your email)
4. Create your stylist profile:
5. Name
6. Salon name

- 7. Years of experience
- 8. Primary color line(s) you use
- 9. You're in! ☐

Recommended device: Tablet (iPad or Android) for salon use — the camera integration works best on a device you can easily handhold near your station.

Step 2: Set Up Your Profile

Before your first formulation, complete your preferences:

- **Primary color line:** Select the brand you use most (Redken, Wella, Schwarzkopf, etc.)
- **Default developer:** Set your preferred developer volumes
- **Units:** Choose oz or ml for measurements
- **Notification preferences:** Turn on/off result reminders

Your First Formulation — Step by Step

3a. Create a New Client

1. From the **Dashboard**, tap "**New Formulation**"
2. Fill in the **Client Questionnaire**:

Question	Why It Matters
Treatment history (straightening, perm, acid)	Chemical treatments change how hair accepts color — affects developer choice and processing
Metallic dye or henna	Critical safety flag — can cause severe reactions with some color lines
Known allergies	Critical safety flag — formulation must avoid allergens
Hair texture (fine/medium/coarse)	Affects processing time and developer volume

Question	Why It Matters
Scalp condition	Sensitive scalps need gentler developer and shorter processing
Previous color services	Determines underlying pigment and how much lift is possible
Desired outcome (touch-up, full, highlights, corrective)	Changes the entire formulation approach
Hair loss or thinning concerns	May require gentler processing and specific product choices

1. Tap "**Continue**"

3b. Photo Capture — Getting It Right

This is the most important step. The AI's accuracy depends entirely on photo quality.

☐ **The Perfect Hair Photo — Checklist:**

☐ **Natural daylight** — Position client near a window. No direct sunlight, but bright indirect light ☐ **6-8 inches away** — Close enough for detail, far enough for context ☐ **Clean, product-free hair** — Dry, no styling products (they alter appearance) ☐ **Even lighting across the head** — Avoid shadows on one side ☐ **Neutral background** — White or light gray wall behind the client

☐ **Avoid these common mistakes:**

- ☐ Harsh overhead salon lights (add false warmth/yellow cast)
- ☐ Flash-only photos (flatten the hair, distort color)
- ☐ Wet hair (water darkens the level by 1-2 levels — AI will read incorrectly)
- ☐ Product-heavy hair (oils, serums, shine sprays alter reflective properties)
- ☐ Dark backgrounds (confuse the AI's edge detection)
- ☐ Filters (any Instagram/Snapchat filter makes the photo useless)

☐ **Take 3 Photos:**

Photo	What to Capture	How to Frame
Top/Crown	Overall natural level	Part hair down center, photograph from above at 45° angle
Mid-lengths	Tone and condition	Pull a section forward, photograph 6-8 inches away
Ends	Damage, buildup, fading	Spread ends flat, photograph from the side

□ Pro Tips from Working Colorists:

- "I take photos at the same window every time — consistency helps the AI learn my lighting conditions." — Sarah M., 12 years
- "If I'm unsure about a reading, I take a second photo from a slightly different angle. It helps confirm the level." — Marcus D., 8 years
- "For dark hair, I always get a mid-lengths shot with the hair spread flat — you can see the underlying pigment better that way." — Jen K., 15 years

3c. Select Desired Color

1. Choose your **color line** (e.g., Redken Shades EQ, Wella Koleston Perfect)
2. Browse or **search for a target shade** (e.g., "09V Platinum Ice")
3. The app shows the shade card with expected results

Beta-supported lines: - Redken (Shades EQ, Color Gels Oils) - Wella (Koleston Perfect, Color Touch) - Schwarzkopf (IGORA Royal, IGORA Vibrance) - Davines (A New Colour, View) - L'Oréal Professionnel (Majirel, DIA Light)

3d. Review Your Formula

ColorGenius generates a personalized formulation card:

- **Primary shade** + ratio (e.g., 09V — 2 oz)
- **Secondary shade** + ratio (if mixing)
- **Developer** volume and amount
- **Processing time** with timer

- **Warnings** (e.g., "Pre-lightening recommended for levels 8+")
- **Confidence score** (how confident the AI is in this formula)

⚠ **Important:** You can adjust any component manually if your professional instinct disagrees — ColorGenius learns from your adjustments. Every override teaches the AI.

3e. Apply, Then Score

After your color service:

1. Return to the formulation
2. Tap **"Score Result"**
3. Take an **after photo** of the finished result (same lighting as the before photo)
4. ColorGenius compares before/after and scores:

Category	What It Measures
Color Accuracy	How close to the target shade? (0-100%)
Hair Condition	Any visible damage, breakage, or compromise?
Evenness	Consistency from root to tip?

1. Add your **personal notes** for next time

Interpreting Results

Understanding Your Formula Card

Element	What It Means	When to Adjust
Primary shade	The dominant color tube	If you know the client's undertone pulls differently
Secondary shade	A modifier or tone adjuster	If you want warmer/cooler results than recommended

Element	What It Means	When to Adjust
Developer volume	How much lift + deposit	For resistant hair, you may need to bump up; for fragile, go down
Processing time	How long to leave on	Adjust based on your experience with the client's hair type
Confidence score	AI's certainty (0-100%)	Scores below 70% mean the AI needs more data — trust your training
Warnings	Safety flags or special instructions	Never ignore warnings — they're based on the questionnaire

Confidence Scores Explained

Score	Meaning	What to Do
90-100%	High confidence — strong data match	Proceed with confidence
70-89%	Good confidence — minor variables	Use your judgment on adjustments
50-69%	Moderate — unusual scenario or limited data	Treat as a starting point, rely on your training
Below 50%	Low confidence — edge case or insufficient data	Use as reference only, formulate manually

Result Scores — What They Mean

Score	Interpretation
90-100% accuracy	Target hit — formula worked as predicted
75-89%	Close result — minor adjustments for next time
50-74%	Noticeable gap — review the formulation notes and report back
Below 50%	

Score	Interpretation
	Significant miss — report this to us immediately via the "Report Issue" button

Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
AI reads the level too dark	Photo taken under warm/low light	Retake photo in natural daylight near a window
AI reads the level too light	Flash used, or hair was wet	Retake without flash, ensure hair is dry
Wrong undertone detected	Color-cast from background or lighting	Use a neutral background (white/gray wall)
"Metallic dye detected" warning appears incorrectly	Heavy product buildup resembling metallic sheen	Clarify the hair and retake; check client history
No formulation generated	Unsupported color line or incomplete questionnaire	Check that your color line is in beta; complete all questionnaire fields
Confidence score is low	Unusual combination of variables	This is normal for edge cases — use your expertise alongside the recommendation
After-photo score seems wrong	Different lighting than before photo	Always use the same lighting setup for before and after photos
App is slow or unresponsive	Internet connectivity	Check Wi-Fi; the app works best on stable connections
Camera won't open	Browser permissions	Allow camera access in your browser settings

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
Formula looks wrong for the client	Questionnaire may have missing info	Double-check all fields, especially treatment history and previous color

Still stuck? Email beta@colorgenius.ai — we respond within 24 hours.

Providing Feedback — You Shape This Product

In-App Feedback (Quick)

- **Thumbs up/down** on every formula result — takes 1 second
- **"Report Issue"** button on any screen — for bugs or wrong recommendations
- **Formula adjustment notes** — when you modify a formula, tell us why

Weekly Beta Survey (5 minutes)

- A short survey lands in your inbox every Monday
- Covers: feature requests, accuracy ratings, friction points

Direct Channel

- **Email:** beta@colorgenius.ai
- **Slack Community:** [join link in your welcome email]
- **Response time:** We reply within 24 hours, guaranteed

What We're Looking For

Area	What to Report
Formula accuracy	Did the recommended formula hit the target?
Photo analysis	Did the AI correctly read the starting color/level?

Area	What to Report
Safety flags	Did warnings catch real risks (allergies, metallic dye)?
Workflow friction	Anything that slows you down at the bowl?
Missing features	What would make this indispensable?
Color line gaps	Shades or brands not yet supported?

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Is ColorGenius a replacement for my color training?

No. ColorGenius augments your expertise. It handles the math and science — level systems, underlying pigments, developer chemistry — so you can focus on the art. Think of it as a calculator for colorists.

2. Which color lines are supported in beta?

Redken, Wella, Schwarzkopf, Davines, and L'Oréal Professionnel. We're adding more based on beta feedback. If your primary line isn't listed, tell us.

3. How accurate is the photo analysis?

90%+ accuracy on well-lit photos. Accuracy depends on lighting quality — natural daylight is best.

4. What happens if the formula is wrong?

Use the "**Report Issue**" button. Trust your training — override any component you disagree with. Every adjustment teaches the AI.

5. Is my client data private?

Absolutely. Client photos and questionnaires are encrypted and never shared. We use anonymized formulation data to improve the AI. Full privacy policy at colorgenius.ai/privacy.

6. Can I use ColorGenius for corrective color?

Yes, but with caveats. The questionnaire includes a "corrective color" option, and the AI accounts for previous services and buildup. Corrective work is the most complex scenario — use ColorGenius as a starting point.

7. What devices work?

Any modern browser — iPhone, iPad, Android, or desktop. Camera integration works on all devices. **Tablet recommended** for salon use.

8. How much does beta cost?

Completely free. Unlimited formulations, all color lines, full features. Beta testers get a **lifetime discount** on future paid plans.

9. What if my color line isn't supported?

Email beta@colorgenius.ai. We can typically add a new line within 2-4 weeks during beta.

10. How do I invite other stylists?

Have them email **beta@colorgenius.ai** with your name as a referral. We prioritize referred stylists for future cohorts.

Beta Timeline & Commitments

Week	Focus
Week 1	Onboarding, first formulations, learn the app
Week 2	Daily use, photo analysis feedback, safety flags
Week 3	Accuracy testing, formula adjustments, edge cases
Week 4	Feature requests, final feedback, transition planning

Your commitments: - Use ColorGenius for **at least 3 formulations per week** - Complete the **weekly survey** (5 min) - Report any **safety concerns immediately** - Share **before/after photos** (with client consent) when possible

Support & Contact

Need	Contact
Bug reports	In-app "Report Issue" button
Feature requests	beta@colorgenius.ai
Urgent/safety	urgent@colorgenius.ai (24hr response)
Community	Slack #beta-stylists channel
General questions	beta@colorgenius.ai

Thank you for being a ColorGenius founding stylist. Your expertise makes this tool better for every colorist who comes after you.

— The ColorGenius Team ☐